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Lab: Workflow Critique and Business Rules Documentation with Generative AI

Estimated time: 30 minutes

Learning objectives

After completing this lab, you will be able to:

- Use AI to critique and improve business workflows by identifying inefficiencies and gaps
- Generate business rules that align with workflow steps
- Create traceability between business rules and workflow documentation

Introduction

In this lab, you will learn how to use AI to review and improve business workflows. You will take a workflow description, use AI to critique it for inefficiencies and gaps, then revise the workflow based on feedback. You will then generate business rules that link directly to workflow steps, creating clear, traceable documentation that ensures every process has supporting guidelines.

Required tools

- Web AI tool (ChatGPT or Claude)
- Workflow description (existing business process or create a sample)

Exercise 1: Critique and improve workflow using AI

In this exercise, you will use AI to analyze a business workflow and identify areas for improvement. AI can spot unclear steps, missing details, bottlenecks, and inefficiencies that may not be obvious. You will review the feedback, decide which changes to implement, and revise your workflow to make it cleaner and more effective.

- Step 1: Submit workflow for AI critique**
- Prepare a workflow description. For example, order fulfillment process, customer onboarding, expense approval, or support ticket resolution.
 - Open your AI tool and paste the workflow description.
 - Prompt the AI to critique the workflow for clarity, completeness, and efficiency.

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Example prompt: "Review this workflow and identify the unclear steps that need clarification, missing details or decision points, bottlenecks or delays in the process, redundant or unnecessary steps, and opportunities to improve efficiency. For each issue, explain why it's a problem and suggest how to fix it."

Step 2: Analyze AI feedback and prioritize improvements

- Review the AI's critique carefully, noting specific issues identified.
- Categorize feedback into critical issues (blocking problems), efficiency improvements (ways to speed up the process), and clarity enhancements (making steps easier to understand).
- Decide which improvements to implement based on impact and feasibility.

Step 3: Revise workflow based on feedback

- Update your workflow description to address the identified issues.
- Add missing steps, clarify ambiguous instructions, and remove redundancies.
- Ensure each step has clear inputs, actions, decision points, and outputs.

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Improved workflow structure: Step 1: [Actor] receives [input] → Step 2: [Actor] performs [action] → Decision: if [condition], then [path A], else [path B] → Step 3: [Actor] delivers [output]. Each step should clearly state who does what, with what information, and what happens next.

Exercise 2: Generate and link business rules to workflow

In this exercise, you will use AI to generate business rules that govern how each workflow step should be executed. Business rules define constraints, validations, and decision criteria. You will ensure each rule has a unique identifier and links directly to specific workflow steps, creating complete traceability between your process and its governing rules.

Step 1: Generate business rules using AI

- Provide your revised workflow to the AI tool.
- Prompt the AI to generate business rules for each workflow step with unique IDs.
- Review the generated rules to ensure they cover validations, constraints, and decision criteria.

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Example prompt: "Generate business rules for this workflow. For each step, create rules that define: validation requirements (what must be checked), constraints (what limits or restrictions apply), decision criteria (how to choose between paths), and exception handling (what to do when something goes wrong). Format each rule as [Rule ID] - [Rule Description] - [linked to Workflow Step X]

Step 2: Link business rules to workflow steps

- Review the generated business rules and identify which workflow step each rule supports.
- Create a mapping table showing: Workflow Step Number → Step Description → Linked Business Rule IDs.
- Verify that every workflow step has at least one associated business rule.

Step 3: Validate completeness and alignment

- Check that all business rules reference valid workflow steps.
- Ensure no workflow steps are missing business rules.
- Verify that rules are clear, actionable, and testable.

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Sample rule-to-workflow mapping: Workflow Step 1: Customer submits order == BR-001: Order must include valid customer ID | BR-002: Order total must be > \$0 | BR-003: Payment method must be verified. Workflow Step 2: System validates inventory == BR-004: All items must be in stock | BR-005: If item unavailable, notify customer within 24 hours

Summary

In this lab, you used AI to critique and improve a business workflow, and then generated business rules that link to each workflow step. You learned how to identify process inefficiencies, create clear documentation, and establish traceability between workflows and their governing rules. These skills help you build well-documented, maintainable business processes.

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